

CS 673 Project Status Report

Team Name: Admission Alchemists

Date: Apr 16, 2025

Team Members: Joseph Rissman, Yue Zhang, Nitin Krishna Bojji

Prepared By: Joseph Rissman

Status Summary:

The GradAid project is in its final phase of development, with the team focused on completing the MVP and preparing for production release.

This sprint, significant progress was made in refining the application's core functionalities and addressing key implementation details. The team focused on finalizing the integration of the LLM for document generation, enhancing the application workflow, and improving the overall stability and user experience of GradAid.

Key accomplishments include implementing queries and mutations to support program details and recommender information, enhancing application form handling and validation, and developing application document management features. The team also implemented feedback submission functionality and made strides in preparing the application for deployment.

Challenges related to API queries, data handling, and UI inconsistencies were addressed through code refactoring, environment configuration, and collaborative debugging efforts.

The team is now focused on completing the final set of tasks, including UI refinements, thorough testing, and deployment, to ensure a successful launch of GradAid.

Website Development (Yue): During this sprint, Yue focused on several key areas to enhance the user interface and improve overall application functionality.

To provide users with a more streamlined document workflow, Yue implemented a "View all" button within the Application Documents section of the dashboard. This enhancement simplifies navigation and allows users to quickly access all relevant documents.

Significant effort was dedicated to refining the document editor. Yue enabled data fetching from Convex within the editor, incorporated a demo mode for testing purposes, and implemented features to handle application IDs and document types more efficiently. These changes improve the editor's robustness and prepare it for integration with the LLM.

UI consistency and visual appeal were also a priority. Yue implemented styling updates across various components, including the application details page and dashboard cards, to ensure a cohesive and user-friendly design.

In addition to these enhancements, Yue addressed several bugs and refined existing features. This included fixing issues related to header breadcrumb display, application card alignments, and navigation within the application.

These collective efforts have resulted in a more polished, functional, and user-friendly GradAid application, bringing the project closer to its MVP release.

Database Development (Joseph): During this sprint, Joseph focused on refining and expanding the application's backend functionality, with a strong emphasis on enhancing data handling, improving application workflows, and preparing for production deployment.

Joseph implemented key API queries to facilitate efficient retrieval of program details and recommender information for the LLM integration. These queries incorporate error handling and validation to ensure data integrity.

To streamline the application process, Joseph addressed issues related to application form submission and validation, incorporating features such as a custom deadline date picker and Zod form validation. He also added the application form itself and implemented the application creation process, integrating it with the useApply hook and updating the ProgramApplyPage. Furthermore, Joseph implemented the functionality to create and update applications, developing the CreateApplicationForm component and enhancing the useApply hook.

Significant refactoring efforts were undertaken to improve code organization and maintainability. This included refactoring API import paths using a new alias, updating queries and validators to use constants, restructuring application and document handling logic, and refining the useDocumentEditor hook. Joseph also implemented Convex validators and TypeScript types to enhance data validation.

In preparation for deployment, Joseph addressed various infrastructure-related tasks, including Netlify setup, GitHub and environment configuration, and large dataset rendering bugs.

These efforts have significantly advanced the GradAid project, enhancing its functionality, maintainability, and readiness for production.

AI Model Development (Nitin): During this sprint, Nitin wrote a prompt template for AI document generation.

Project Overview:

Task	Owner	%Done	Due Date	Notes
Complete Program Search Page	Joseph	95%	Mar 12	Fix minor bugs with search filters
Populate Additional Example Data in Database	Nitin	50%	Mar 26	
Complete Application Tracking Page	Yue	90%	Apr 2	
Design Interactive Document Editor	Yue	100%	Apr 2	
Complete Application Tracking Page (Functionality)	Yue	100%	Apr 2	
Complete Document Viewing/Editing Page	Yue	95%	Apr 16	
Add buttons on the application details page so that users can edit any document	Yue	100%	Apr 16	
Integrate Document Editing Page with backend	Joseph	95%	Apr 16	
Fully Integrate LLM API with Database	Nitin	15%	Apr 16	
Allow multiple applications under a university	Yue	100%	Apr 16	
Add mutation to save document text changes	Yue	100%	Apr 16	
Improve AI credits system	Joseph	20%	Apr 30	
Add unit tests to Convex functions	Joseph	0%	Apr 30	
Add integration tests for frontend code	Yue	0%	Apr 30	
Add empty states for application and document pages	Yue	0%	Apr 30	
Implement delete functionality for applications and documents	Joseph	0%	Apr 30	
Write CRUD Functions on Convex Server	Joseph	~95%	Apr 30	Ongoing task
Refactor Website with Shadcn Components	Yue	~95%	Apr 30	Ongoing task

Risk And Issue History

Issue	Assigned To	Date
LLM API Integration with Database Pending	Nitin	Mar 19
Document generation functionality limited to local execution	Nitin	Mar 19

Problems encountered with useApplicationDetails hook due to conditional logic and multiple returns	Joseph	Apr 9
Issues identified with Convex typing and component structure	Yue	Apr 9
Validation issue with the GRE toggle	Yue	Apr 9
Merge conflicts requiring resolution	Yue & Joseph	Apr 16